Computer Science

Full Study Notes

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1. Computer Architecture

1.1. Introduction

Computer architecture is the structure of a computer system made from component parts.

1.2. CPU

- The CPU (**C**entral-**P**rocessing-**U**nit) is the square component we saw in class inside the computer.
- It consists of many smaller units that handle different things, but in the explanation we will take, it will only contain an ALU 1.2.1 and a CU 1.2.2, both of their explanations will be simplified.
- It's essentially the brain of the computer, handling all the computation (we can call them tasks) that happen on the computer.



Figure 1: A physical CPU

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1.2.1. ALU

- The ALU (**A**rithmetic-**L**ogic-**U**nit) is a component/unit of the CPU 1.2
- It handles all the arithmetic (addition, subtraction, division, multiplication, etc...)
- All the operations that happen inside the ALU are in base-2

1.2.2. CU

- The CU (**C**ontrol-**U**nit) is a component/unit of the CPU 1.2
- It will manage and execute instructions.
- For now, we will think of instructions as operations needed to perform certain actions on the computer (adding two numbers, opening an app, etc...)

1.2.3. CPU Characteristics

- A CPU has a clock speed: the speed of which instructions will execute, and it is a frequency.
- $1\text{GHz} = 1 * 10^9$ Hz

1.3. Memory

> Memory in the context of a computer system is the place where "data" will be stored. Data can be for example: images, text, files, Variables 2.3, etc...

We will discuss:

- Two types of memory: Primary Memory and Secondary Memory
- Data units: bit, byte, KB, MB, GB

Primary Memory	Secondary Memory
Fast access speed	Slower access speed
Volatile (data lost on restart)	Non-volatile (data persists)
Example: **RAM**	Example: **HDD, SSD**
Used for active tasks	Used for long-term storage

1.3.1. RAM

- RAM (**R**andom-**A**ccess-**M**emory) is the a type of memory. It's the green sticks I've shown you in class.
- RAM is primary memory.

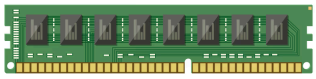


Figure 2: A physical stick of RAM

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1.3.2. HDD

- HDD (Hard-Disk-Drive) is a type of memory. It's the metal square Ive shown you in class.
- HDD is secondary-memory.



Figure 3: An HDD

1.4. Converting data sizes (Decimal System - SI)

Unit	Conversion
Bit	Smallest data unit
Byte	1 byte = 8 bits
Kilobyte (KB)	1 KB = 1,000 bytes
Megabyte (MB)	1 MB = 1,000 KB
Gigabyte (GB)	1 GB = 1,000 MB

1.5. Number Systems

1.5.1. Base-10

- Base-10 is the number system we humans use.
- It's made up of 10 digits, digits from (0 to 9): 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9.
- Any other number is made up from these the 10 digits.

1.5.2. Base-2

- Base-2 is the number system is computers use.
- It's made up of two digits: `0` and `1`.
- Any other number is made up from these the 2 digits.

1.5.3. Relationship between base-2 and base-10

Numbers can be converted to-and-back from base-2 to base-10.

1.5.3.1. Converting from Base-10 to Base-2

Example: Convert $(75)_{10}$ to binary

Step 1: Make a table.

Step 2: Divide 75 by 2 repeatedly.

Step 3: If the number is a decimal, take everything before the decimal and assign it the bit `1`; if the number is a whole number, write the number as is and assign it the bit `0`.

Step 4: Construct the number by reading the bits from bottom to top.

number	index	bit
37	0	1
18	1	1
9	2	0
4	3	1
2	4	0
1	5	0
$\frac{1}{2}$	6	1

Table 1: Table for converting 75 to base-2.

1.5.3.2. Converting from Base-2 to Base-10

We will take the same example as above and in Table 1, and we will use the indexes to remake the base-10 number.

we had $(75)_{10} = (1001011)_2$

We need to only consider the "1"s and their indexes as shown in Figure 4

$(1001011)_2 = (2^0 + 2^1 + 2^3 + 2^6)_{10} = (75)_{10}$

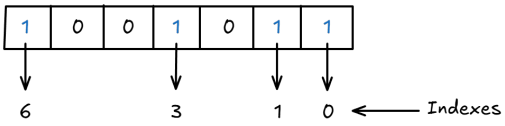


Figure 4: The 1's and their indexes.

2. Python

2.1. Introduction

Definition: Python is a “high-level”, “interpreted”, “general-purpose” scripting language.

Characteristic	Explanation
High-Level	Built on many lower-level abstractions. Python provides an easy-to-use language by building upon harder programming concepts and technologies.
Interpreted	An external program (the interpreter) reads and executes instructions line by line. Unlike compiled languages, Python code is interpreted at runtime.
General-Purpose	Can be used for most use-cases. Python is versatile: web development, data science, automation, etc.
Sequential	Executes instructions from top to bottom by default.
Imperative	Uses imperative programming style to maintain state.

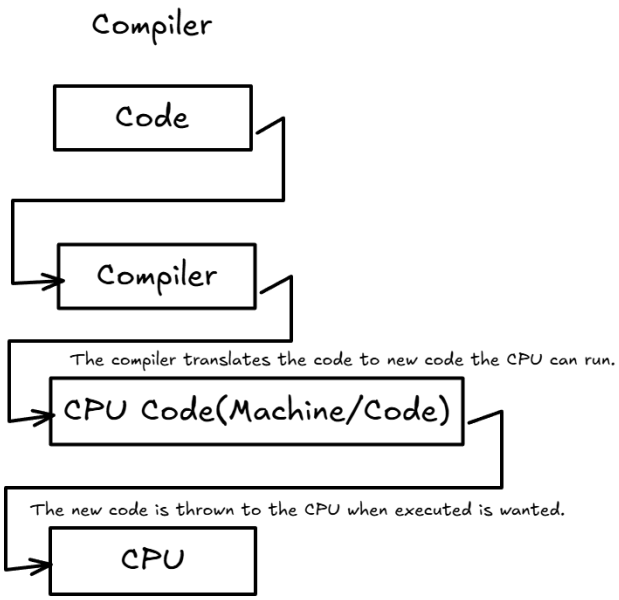


Figure 5: Compiled languages process.

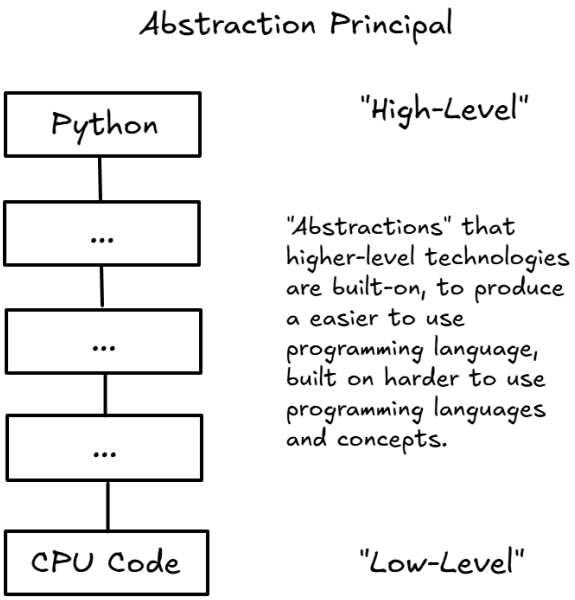


Figure 6: Abstractions.

2.2. Data Types

Type	Description & Examples
`int`	Integer - a whole number. Examples: `10`, `25`, `300`, `-5`
`float`	Decimal number. Examples: `52.6`, `19.3`, `1.0`, `5.0`
`bool`	Boolean - either `True` or `False`
`str`	String - sequence of characters. Examples: `"Hello"`, `"Text"`, `""`
`list`	Sequence of elements. Example: `[10, 5.2, 9.8]` Lists are heterogeneous and 0-indexed List indexing is non-commutative
`dict`	Dictionary - key-value store. Example: `{"name": "John", "age": 30}` Access: `person["name"]` ⟶ `"John"`
`None`	Represents a null value

2.3. Variables

Variables in Python are **mutable** (can change) and **untyped** (no specific type restriction).

examples:

```
name = "Johnny"
johnny_age = 20
grades = [10, 5.2, 9.8, 12.5, 13.2]
person = {"name": "John", "age": johnny_age}
```

2.4. Operators

2.4.1. Arithmetic operators

Operator	Name	Example
+	Addition	`10 + 5 = 15`
-	Subtraction	`10 - 5 = 5`
*	Multiplication	`10 * 5 = 50`
/	Division	`10 / 5 = 2.0`
**	Exponentiation	`3 ** 4 = 3 * 3 * 3 * 3 = 81`

Important: Division always returns a float: `int / int → float`

2.4.2. Comparison operators

Operator	Name	Result
==	Equality	`10 == 10` ⟶ `True`
!=	Inequality	`10 != 5` ⟶ `True`
>	Greater than	`10 > 5` ⟶ `True`
<	Less than	`10 < 5` ⟶ `False`
>=	Greater or equal	`10 >= 10` ⟶ `True`
<=	Less or equal	`5 <= 10` ⟶ `True`

2.4.3. Logical Operators On A Truth Table

p	q	**Conjunction** p **and** q $p \wedge q$	**Disjunction** p **or** q $p \vee q$	**Negation not** p $\neg p$	**Negation not** q $\neg q$
True	True	True	True	False	False
True	False	False	True	False	True
False	True	False	True	True	False
False	False	False	False	True	True

2.4.4. Operation + Assignment By Examples

All the arithmetic, and bitshift operators have an assignment equivalent used to modify variables.

```
# We will declare these variables for example purposes
first_number = 10
second_number = 5
first_string = "John"
second_string = "Johhny"

first_string += " Jason" # first_string will be "John Jason" after that, because "John"
+ " Jason" = "John Jason".
second_number -= 6 # second_number will be -1 after that, because 5 - 6 = -1.
second_number *= -2 # second_number will be 2 after that, because (-1)(-2) = 2.
first_number /= 5 # first_number will be 2.0 after that, because 10 / 5 = 2.0.
```

```
first_number = 5 # first_number will be 5 after that, normal assignment.
first_number <<= 2 # first_number will be 20 after that, because 5 << 2 = 20
first_number >>= 3 # first_number will be 2 after that, because 20 >> 3 is 2.
```

2.5. Loops

Loops are used for repeated actions.

2.5.1. A visual

```
accumulator = 0 # A variable that accumulates

for current_number in range(0, 10): # A loop over the range 0 to 10 (10 exclusive), and
current_number is the current value from the range
  accumulator += current_number # Mutating accumulator and adding current_number to it
```

After this, `accumulator` will be $0 + 1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 5 + 6 + 7 + 8 + 9 = 45$.

2.5.2. Example: Using lists to match two n-length lists

```
names  = ["John", "Johnnathan", "Jay", "Jane", "Jake"] # List of n names
grades = [9, 7.5, 6, 3.5, 6] # List of n grades
n      = 5

for i in range(0, n): # Looping n times
  name = names[i] # Accessing the n-th name from the names list
  grade = str(grades[i]) # Accessing the n-th grade from the grades list, and converting
it to a string, the same way we would do with an int(...)
  print(name + " has a grade of " + grade) # Concatenating (Adding) the strings together
to make a sentence, here we see why we turned grade into a "str", because str + int is
not possible
```

The output is as shown below:

```
John has a grade of 9
Johnnathan has a grade of 7.5
Jay has a grade of 6
Jane has a grade of 3.5
Jake has a grade of 6
```

2.5.3. Using lists without the range function

Until now, we are still using the `range` function, but are **iterable** by default. An iterator allows any object to be **iterated over** by a loop. Let's compare:

```python
nums = [1,2,3,4,5]
n = 5

for i in range(0, n):
  print(nums[i])
```

Code 1: Looping over lists with range

```python
nums = [1,2,3,4,5]

for num in nums:
  print(num)
```

Code 2: Looping over lists with the list's iterative property

2.6. Functions

Functions should be thought as machines that take an input and give us an output.



Figure 7: Function diagram

2.6.1. A visual

```python
def add(x, y):
  return x + y
```

Code 3: A function that adds two numbers, x and y.

Now, to use this function we just **defined**, we will need to **call** it, as such:

```python
result = add(10, 5)
print(result)
```

Code 4: Calling the function add

The output of result will now be `15`, since the function handled the addition of `x` and `y`, and `x` was `10`, and `y` was `5`.

2.6.2. Parameters & Arguments

- The parameters of a function is what we label the inputs. Consider Code 3, the parameters of that function are `x` and `y`.
- The arguments of a function is what is supplied for the labels of the inputs. Consider Code 4, the arguments are `10` and `5`.

2.6.3. Returning Values

The **return value** of a function is what the function outputs. Taking as example Code 3, the return value can be described as `x + y`, or also the sum of its inputs.

The return value is also what comes after the **return** keyword.

2.6.4. Deterministic & Pure function

Function Characteristic	Definition
Deterministic Function	A deterministic function is a function that returns the same outputs for the same inputs, and has no randomness in the determination of future states.

2.6.5. Using functions to calculate the hypotenuse of a right triangle ABC

```
def calculate_hypotenuse(AB, AC):
  BC = (AB**2 + AC ** 2) ** 0.5
  return BC
```

We can describe this function as follows:

- This function is called `calculate_hypotenuse`.
- It takes two parameters: AB and AC, which are supposed to be either int's or floats.
- It returns the hypotenuse of the triangle ABC.

2.6.6. Functions to be aware of

2.6.6.1. print

Output to the standard output (simplified).

```
>>> print("Hello World")
--> Hello World
```

2.6.6.2. int

Returns an integer constructed from a number or a string.

```
int(123.45) # 123
int("123") # 123
int("01110011", base=2) # 115
```

2.6.6.3. range

Range is technically a *class* not a function, but we will refer to it as a function. We will consider valid arguments to be integers.

Refer to Loops 2.5 to know how to use it.

2.7. Control Flow

Control flow describes how execution progresses from one command to the next.

2.7.1. A visual

```
your_age = 15
adult_age = 18

if your_age >= adult_age:
  print("You are an adult")
else:
  print("You are a minor")
```

Code 5: Control flow, if and else.

In the code above, we have two variables, `your_age` and `adult_age`.

We first compare `your_age` and `adult_age` using `>=` (Bigger than or equal to), which returns a bool type, this bool type is then considered by the **if** statement before it, and accordingly, the **branch** below if (the truthy-case branch) will be executed, otherwise, we are handling it with an **else** statement.

2.7.2. If statements

if executes it's branch if the statement given to it is a truthy value, a **truthy** value is a value that is not **falsy**.

Some **falsy** values in Python are: `None`, `0` and `False`

truthy values evaluate to **True** booleans, and **falsy** values evaluate to **False** booleans.

The structure of an **if statement** looks as such:

```
if boolean:
  branch instructions
```

2.7.3. Else statements

else statements are chained with **if** statements, and are executed in case the previous **if statement** turns out to be falsy, the structure is as such:

```
if boolean:
  branch instructions
else:
  branch instructions
```

One thing possible with **else** statements is chaining them with if statements, as such:

```
if boolean:
  branch instructions
elif boolean:
  branch instructions
elif boolean:
  branch instructions
else:
  branch instructions
```

Here, we have an if statement, chained with else statements, and a default case.

2.7.4. Using control flow to categorize age

```
age = 30

if age >= 60:
    print("You're a senior!")
elif age >= 40:
    print("You're an adult!")
elif age >= 20:
    print("You're a young adult!")
elif age >= 13:
    print("You're a teenager!")
elif age >= 3:
    print("You're a child!")
else:
    print("You're an infant!")
```

2.8. Try it yourself

You can go to the website: https://www.programiz.com/python-programming/online-compiler/, and follow everything each step of the way, maybe even ask AI but Ill be pretty upset if I found out :(

3. Exam studying methodology

- Focus on understanding the concepts before memorizing them, there's not even the need to memorize them.
- 20% of the event yields 80% of the outcome, don't try and nail all the details, just focus on the most important things.
- Focus on the English parts of things and try to explain thing to yourself and other people to see if you understand.
- Regarding Python, you can try everything each step of the way, read Try it yourself 2.8
- Ask me in the group if there's any questions, not in private, I won't respond.

Good Luck! I want good grades.

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